



Kindergarten Learning Progression Toolkit

Language and Literacy Fact Sheet

Supporting reconciliation

Acknowledgement of Country

We acknowledge the Traditional Owners of the lands, seas, skies and waterways from across Queensland.

We pay our respect to the Elders past and present, for they hold the memories, traditions, the culture and hopes of Aboriginal peoples and Torres Strait Islander peoples.

A better understanding and respect for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultures develops an enriched appreciation of Australia's cultural heritage and can lead to reconciliation.

This is essential to the maturity of Australia as a nation and fundamental to the development of an Australian identity.

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Language and Literacy

Language and literacy are important skills that help children communicate, connect with others, share their ideas and understand their world. These skills include spoken word, sign language, facial expressions, listening, picture cues and other Augmentative and Alternative Communication (AAC) tools like communication boards or speech generating devices.

By supporting each child's strengths and individual communication methods, we can foster their language and literacy development, helping them build confidence and feel a sense of belonging.

Language and literacy learning in the KLPT focuses on communication skills and literacy related language including age and developmentally appropriate exposure to text and stories. These skills develop over time and are shaped by who children are, their identity, culture, the language they speak at home, and their daily experiences.

Recognising and valuing Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander languages in Queensland supports language preservation and celebrates children's strengths in speaking multiple languages.

Some children use more than one language and may switch between their home language and English depending on the situation. This is called code-switching and is a strength that enables children to adapt their language use to suit different contexts.

Children show literacy behaviours when they pretend to read, write or use images and print in their play, including on devices. These everyday actions help them understand how language works.

Children's use of their home languages underpins their sense of identity and their conceptual development. Children's sense of belonging is strengthened when their language, interaction styles and ways of communicating are valued. They have the right to be continuing users of their home language, as well as to develop competency in Standard Australian English. (EYLF V.2.0, 2022, p.57).



Teachers and educators play a key role in supporting diverse ways of expressing, understanding and connecting. They can extend children's language and literacy by:

- creating literacy rich environments indoors and outdoors
- planning for literacy rich play-based learning experiences
- asking open-ended questions to encourage deeper thinking
- modelling rich vocabulary and storytelling
- valuing children's cultural, linguistic, family and individual diversity.

Teachers and educators can observe how children increasingly use language and literacy by noticing how they understand, express and connect ideas through play, storytelling and everyday interactions. Children's ways of making meaning are shaped by their language, culture and community.

Speech and sounds: vocabulary, sentence construction and coherence

Children build and organise language when they:

- use a growing range of words in conversations and play.
- create sentences that make sense to others.
- sequence ideas and connect thoughts when telling stories, giving explanations or asking questions about the world around them.

NQS links: Quality Areas 1, 3, 5 and 6

QKLG (2024) links: Identity, connectedness and communicating

Speech and sounds: phonological and phonemic awareness

Children show awareness of sounds in words when they:

- notice and play with rhyming words.
- break words into syllables or individual sounds.
- connect sounds to letters when beginning to read and write.

Comprehension

Children show they understand and create meaning when they:

- follow instructions and daily routines.
- retell stories or events using words, signs, pictures or AAC.
- explain the meaning of drawings, marks or 'writing.'

Every child brings unique strengths to their language and literacy journey. By supporting diverse ways of learning and communicating, teachers and educators help all children thrive.

Supporting resources

Find out more about supporting children's language and literacy:

- **Foundations for Success**
- **Early Years Learning Framework**
- **Queensland kindergarten learning guideline**
- **National Quality Standard**
- **Engaging with families from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds**
- **BELONGING, BEING & BECOMING: Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander perspectives**